2026-03-01 — Customs and Tefillot of ליל שבת במה מדליקין and, אנא בכח, כגוונא —

*Content-based review · checked against the PRIMARY transcript, the bilingual Hebrew-English Sofer-style text 03-01 Lecture_ Jewish Customs and Prayers for Leil Shabbos.txt (no timestamps, so passages are cited by quoted phrase, shown as ["…"]) · the Plaud transcript (speaker-labelled, heavily garbled) and the Plaud summary were used only as secondary checks · reviewer read the draft as it stood in final MM before the Sefaria step · 1 March 2026 · 12 Adar 5786 (computed) · the corrections marked **[applied]** were made to the shiur HTML in the Sefaria step of this run; the rest are recommendations carried into the Sefer Edition*

1.The Shiur in One Paragraph

A Sunday-morning shiur, continuing the series on the Friday-night service, opening with a dedication (breakfast sponsored by Rav Abbie לעילוי נשמת his father and father-in-law, שמואל צבי בן יהושע פייביש הכהן) and a long, partly humorous prologue: the author of מנות הלוי אלקבץ רב שלמה הלוי, לכה דודי, also wrote הלוי, a commentary on Esther; Mottie Goldish sent an article that the head of the Shabak, David Zini (an alumnus of ישיבת שבי חברון, where a כולל is to be launched after Pesach), was seen in the situation room with that very ספר on the table; and a Boro Park Rebbe's Yiddish saying that one need not listen to the news but make news, by learning and davening. The Rav then fills gaps from the previous week. Why אנא בכח between מזמור לדוד and לכה דודי? It is based on the שם בן מ״ב; the Aruch HaShulchan links it to מעשה בראשית (Chagigah 11b, Tosafos). Standing for all of לכה דודי (Chabad, perhaps Syrians), bowing left-right-center, and why לכה דודי is omitted when Yom Tov falls on Erev Shabbos (a בזיון יום טוב, which the Rav says he does not understand). He then turns to במה מדליקין and כגוונא: the original Geonic custom (Rav Nachshon Gaon, Rav Amram Gaon) was to say it after Kaddish at the end of davening, for the latecomers; the Rishonim (Machzor Vitry) give a reminder reason, and the Abudraham wished to move it before Maariv; a third

reason is the Karaite challenge, told through the biography of Anan (Chaninai Gaon, the Bostanai family, jail, the Karaite shuls in Ashdod and the Old City, his grave on Har HaZeisim). כגוונא is a Zohar passage first put into the siddur by the Baal Shem Tov and his students; the Piaseczner Rebbe (his biography, and the חובת התלמידים) says it gives נחת רוח on high; the closing paragraph and ברכו. Finally the Chayei Adam (Avraham Danzig, 1748–1820), the first source to put במה מדליקין between Kabbalas Shabbos and Maariv, which the Rav proposes as a protest by the Misnagdim against the Chassidim. The shiur ends with Tehillim for the hostages and a request for mercy.

2.Overall Fidelity — What the Write-Up Does Well

- **The main architecture follows the shiur.** The order (Ana Becoach, standing, bowing, Yom Tov, Bameh Madlikin and its three reasons, Kegavna, the Chassidim and Misnagdim) matches the recording, and the three reasons for Bameh Madlikin are correctly counted, with the latecomers first, the reminder second, the Karaites third.

- **The latecomers reason is well told** (shuls outside the city, the long dark walk, מזיקין, a five-to-seven-minute reading) and the "pattern in halachah" callout correctly carries the Rav's point that Chazal were sensitive to latecomers, including the aliyah blessings said before and after.

- **Karaite background is on the right track**: לא תבערו אש בכל מושבותיכם (Sefaria, Exodus 35:3, verified), the cold dark Friday night, and the Rav's point that the whole matter of hot food and light is a statement of belief in the Oral Law.

- **The Rav's opinion that both bowing customs have a source and the real point is the feeling** (הרגש) is faithful.

- **Appropriate omissions.** The jokes about the cake and about who said "Abbie," the asides on the news, the stray roll-call, the Karaite

synagogue's closed door, and the news of the day are properly absent from a study text.

3.Content Flags — What Is Wrong, Mis-Attributed, Omitted, or Added in the Draft

Everything below was tested against the primary text. Items marked **[applied]** were corrected in the shiur HTML in the Sefaria step; the rest are for the Sefer Edition.

Flag 1 — The structure of Ana Becoach is mis-described [applied]. The draft says "each of the seven verses opens with one of the seven words of the Name." Ana Becoach has seven lines of six words, forty-two words in all, whose *initials* are the בן מ״ב . The Rav said only that "the שי תיבות, if you look at any siddur, is the מ״ב " and that for this reason we add ברוך שם מלכותו לעולם ועד, and that it is said quietly (זש). The "seven kolos of Mizmor LeDavid correspond to the seven berachos" is not from the recording.

Flag 2 — The source for the creation link is wrong [applied]. The draft cites Kiddushin 71a as saying the Name was the one "through which the world was created." The Rav's source: the mishnah in Chagigah 11b, אין דורשין במעשה בראשית בשנים; the Tosafos there ("שה בראשית is the מ״ב "); the Aruch HaShulchan, who suggests this is why Ana Becoach is said when we welcome the Shabbos of creation; the Rav "didn't find any other source." Kiddushin 71a does speak of the 42-letter Name, but only of its transmission. Sefaria confirms the mishnah, Kiddushin 71a:13, and not the Tosafos or Aruch HaShulchan passages. The Arizal "institution" of the placement is not in the recording.

Flag 3 — The standing section cites sources the Rav did not and mis-assigns the stricter custom [applied]. The draft cites the Shulchan Aruch 262 and a Rema; the Rav spoke of "most י הלכה and תי חכמים." The stricter custom is that of ד״; the Rav is then told the Syrians do it too, and wonders about Iranians and Ashkenazim ("I will look into that"). The "some printings of the Ari's nusach" is not from the recording. The reason (re-enacting

the Amoraim who went out to greet the bride; turning to the west of the beis medrash) is the Rav's.

Flag 4 — The bowing rationale is invented [applied]. The draft: "a person facing forward has the Shechinah behind him." The Rav: "to your left is the right of the Shechinah, or whatever that means." And his own practice: "Always first to the left. Left, right, center."

Also: the bowing question belonged to the discussion of י כלה, and the Rav mentions that the reason was explained "a year and a half ago" when learning the Korbanos; the draft lost this link.

Flag 5 — Yom Tov Erev Shabbos: invented citations and a reversed attribution [applied]. The draft cites Shulchan Aruch 668 and the Mishnah Berurah; the Rav cited "the Rishonim and Acharonim" for the reason of בזיון יום, and himself did *not* find it intelligible ("I'm not sure, I don't understand it"). The draft's "the shiur pressed on the second reason" reverses what happened: the Rav pressed *against* both, noting that the kedushah of Shabbos is higher (אוכל נשמה יתירה, ו). A participant offered מערבין שמחה בשמחה. The Rav also notes that נא is not said then either. Sefaria shows Shulchan Aruch OC 668 is about Shemini Atzeret; the Tur (OC 270) records only that Ashkenazim omit *Bameh Madlikin* on such a night because they cannot say עש.רתם

Flag 6 — The contents of the closing mishnah of Bameh Madlikin are wrong [applied]. The draft says the perek ends with ובי תבשילין, "an eiruv of tavshilin if also Yom Tov," and the "עות of one's meal." The Rav quoted the mishnah: עשרתם: שה דברים צריך אדם לומר בתוך ביתו ערב שבת עם חשכה (tithed?), בתם (eiruv chatzeiros), ליקו את הנר. The Rav also explained why the perek is about oils and wicks (ה הנר: tilting the lamp, a desecration of Shabbos).

Flag 7 — Attributions of the three reasons [applied]. (a) Reason 1 is attributed to the Tur "in the name of the Geonim"; the Rav gave it in the name of נחשון גאון, and said the earliest source for saying the perek at all is Rav Amram Gaon and Rav Nachshon Gaon, *after Kaddish at the end of davening*. Sefaria's Tur (OC 270) does not give this reason. (b) Reason 2 is attributed to the

Abudraham and "brought in the Tur"; the Rav gave it in the name of the מחזור יי "and other Rishonim"; the *Abudraham* is the one who proposed moving the perek to before Maariv. The Rav called him "יי כהן אבודרהם"; the author is David Abudraham, and the draft's footnote was right. Sefaria's Beis Yosef (OC 270) does say it is "more correct" to say it before Maariv. (c) Reason 3 is attributed to the Beis Yosef; the Rav said "some Rishonim" and named no source; the retrieved Beis Yosef text does not contain it.

Flag 8 — Anan is compressed and slightly altered (Reason 3) [partly applied]. The Rav's account: the Resh Galusa was Rav Chaninai Gaon (d. 770); Anan was his grandson, of the family of תנאי (descended from David HaMelech); the sages refused him; he informed against them to the authorities in Baghdad and was himself jailed; released after a few months, he did become Resh Galusa, and then followed the Karaites; the "Ananites"; a Karaite synagogue named for him in Ashdod; he went up to Jerusalem and built a synagogue in the Old City (the Karaite synagogue); he is buried on Har HaZeisim. The draft keeps only "passed over for his uncle" and "turned in protest." The Rav also states that the Geonim Rav Natronai, Rav Hai or Rav Amram wrote of the perek in their siddurim "right after Anan left," and that "many say it makes no difference when you say it." Historians generally say Anan was passed over (and his brother appointed); this stands as the Rav's account, flagged in the HTML note.

Flag 9 — Kegavna: description of its contents is invented [applied]. The draft says the passage describes "the elevation of the sefirot, unification of worlds," "disconnect from the language and concerns of the weekday," and ends "זו רזא דאחד." The Rav said only that it speaks of שולטני רוגזין (all the judgments do not exist on Shabbos) and praises and elevates the stature of Shabbos; that nothing in the Zohar says to say it before Maariv; and that it is "a Chassidic custom from the students of the Baal Shem Tov, nothing before." The Rav's tangent on דשבת sung by Nissim Saal, and the remark that Chassidic Rebbes say it with fire, are omitted.

Flag 10 — The Piaseczner section cites the wrong work and invents the guidance [applied]. The Rav's source is ת התלמידים (not "בני מחשבה ה"): if a Jew says Kegavna with kavanah, with joy and love, taking upon himself the kedushah of Shabbos, Hashem has great נ רוח in heaven ("how

does he know? I don't know"). The draft's "after Kabbalas Shabbos but before Maariv, not rushed, not whispered" is not in the Sofer text (the Plaud summary says "after Kabbalat Shabbos and Maariv," a garble). The biography is also thin: killed in 1943; his son, daughter-in-law and sister-in-law were killed in the 1939 bombing of Warsaw; the Piaseczna rabbinate; the yeshiva in Warsaw; the דים who begged him to flee; Rabbi Weinberger's קודש shul; the Carlebach stories; Rabbi Milech Biderman as a comparison.

Flag 11 — The "baruch hu" section answers a question the Rav did not ask [applied]. The Plaud summary says "a small paragraph at the end of Kigavna contains 'baruch hu.'" The Sofer text has no such discussion. The Rav's question is about ו:: the final small-print paragraph ends המברך ' וא ברכו את ה; we do not say ו: alone without ten, but one who davens alone says it "as a piece of Zohar that you're learning," not as ו:; the Artscroll note says it is for the תפילה י. The draft's "answering baruch hu while davening privately" is wholly derived from the summary's error.

Flag 12 — Section VI misplaces the Sefardi placement and states the Rav's theory as fact [applied]. The draft says the Sefardim "retained the original after-Maariv placement." In the Sofer text the original placement (Geonim, then Spain, Germany and France) was at the end of davening; later (Amsterdam, London, Spain, Portugal) after Lecha Dodi, before Mizmor Shir; and the Rav and his Sefardi participants disagree on what they themselves say ("before Kabbalas Shabbos," says the participant). Sefaria's Shulchan Aruch OC 270:1 says the Sefaradim say it before Maariv. The Rav also presents the Misnagdic-protest reading as "this is the theory," twice, not as a documented fact, and he does not say that the Vilna Gaon "regarded Kegavna as illegitimate." The Chayei Adam: born 1748, died 1820 ("I think"), lived in Danzig and Vilna, a businessman who writes in his introduction that he does not take money for Torah; the most popular halachic work ("ask your grandparents"); a תן of the Vilna Gaon (his son married the Gaon's granddaughter, "something like that," which the draft also dropped and which I could not confirm). Sefaria's Chayei Adam 31 does not contain the passage.

Flag 13 — The opening of the shiur is lost. The draft starts at Ana Becoach and omits the dedication (which the Sefer Edition should keep), the Alkabetz /

Manos HaLevi link, the מען דארף מאכן נייעס, דארף נישט הערן נייעס saying (worth a place in the lead or the dedication), and the Shavei Hebron kollel announcement. The Zini story is current news and best omitted from a sefer; the Plaud summary's "Har Etzion" for Zini's yeshiva does not match the Sofer text ("Shavei Hebron"), and neither was checked.

Flag 14 — Questions and tangents dropped from the middle. Shabbos Chanukah and Bameh Madlikin (a questioner says it is not said; the Rav points to the sugya of Shabbos 25–28 and to the "Karaite-style" book he looked up online); the Young Israel of Lawrence-Cedarhurst still saying Kaddish in shul; early Shabbos acceptance after plag; "Rav Sheshes"; the Reish Galusa who cut off a woman's nose (Teshuvos HaRashba); Marcus Lehmann's novel on the Bostanai; the participant who says Sefardim say Bameh Madlikin *before* Kabbalas Shabbos. The historical ones (Chaninai, Bostanai, Karaite shuls, exilarchs) are in keeping with the Rav's preference for historical detail and are restored in the Sefer Edition.

4.Primary vs. Plaud, Remaining Garbles, and the Mareh Mekomos

Item	Primary (Sofer-style .txt)	Plaud transcript / summary	Resolution
Zini's yeshiva	ישיבת שבי חברון; "David Bini"	Summary: "Yeshivat Har Etzion"; "David Zini"	Follow primary; name is the Shabak head David Zini; yeshiva not verified
Sponsor	Rav Abbie, שמואל צבי בן יהושע פייביש הכהן (father, father-in-law)	"Rabbi Lila Mishnah"	Follow primary
Kegavna /	ולימא ברכו; no	Summary:	Plaud summary

"baruch hu"	"baruch hu"	"baruch hu"	wrong
Piaseczner	חובת התלמידים; joy and love	Summary: "after Kabbalat Shabbos and Maariv"	Follow primary
Chayei Adam	"first source"; "this is the theory"	Summary: "first source"; "fiercely opposed"	Keep as the Rav's theory
Assignments	—	8 invented assignments	Not carried over

The Mareh Mekomos of the draft (14 notes): notes 1, 2, 12 and 13 describe sources not discussed in the shiur; notes 3, 4, 5, 7, 8, 9, 14 carried the errors above and were corrected; note 6 and note 10 were adjusted. The note-academic flags on notes 2, 12 and 13 stand honestly as uncertain.

5.Recommended Corrections for the Sefer Edition

1. Open with the dedication and with רב שלמה הלוי אלקבץ's מנות הלוי; keep the "make news" saying; omit the Zini story and political detail.
2. **Ana Becoach:** seven lines, six words; the Rav's single suggestion (Aruch HaShulchan) and "no other source"; add בלחש and ברוך שם כבוד מלכותו.
3. **Standing / bowing:** Chabad, Syrians; "always left first."
4. **Yom Tov:** the Rav's perplexity; the second reason's weakness; Kegavna not said then.
5. **Bameh Madlikin:** the mishnah of the three things; the Gaonic placement after Kaddish; Rav Nachshon; the Abudraham's proposal; Anan in full, as the Rav's account, with the note that the standard

account differs.

6. **Kegavna and the Piaseczner:** the Zohar's כל שולטני רוגזין; the Baal Shem Tov; the חובת התלמידים; the Piaseczner's biography; the ברכו paragraph.
7. **Chayei Adam:** the biography; "first source"; the theory of protest, as the Rav's.
8. **Mark "Sefard" and "Sefardim" carefully:** the Rav uses "nusach Sefard" for the Chassidic rite and "Sefardim" for the Spanish-Portuguese communities, and sometimes slips between them.

6.Follow-up Questions Worth Asking the Rav, and Bottom Line

Q1.Where in the Aruch HaShulchan does he suggest the link between Ana Becoach and מעשה בראשית, and which Tosafos in Chagigah 11b does the Rav mean?

Q2.Which Rishonim give the Karaite reason, and is it the Rav's view that Anan himself held the office of Resh Galusa (the standard account differs)?

Q3.What does the Chayei Adam say, and where, about the placement of Bameh Madlikin? Was the Chayei Adam really מחותן of the Vilna Gaon?

Q4.Where in the חובת התלמידים does the Piaseczner speak of Kegavna?

Q5.What is the Rav's custom today for Bameh Madlikin and Kegavna in his own shul, and is "nusach Sefard" used for the Chassidic rite or the Spanish-Portuguese?

Q6.Did the Rav mean that the Karaite reason produced the placement between Kabbalas Shabbos and Maariv, or only the saying of the perek at all?

Against the primary transcript, the draft is a readable and well-organized account whose spine (three reasons for Bameh Madlikin, Kegavna, the Chassidim and Misnagdim) is right, but whose citations and several explanations were supplied by the draft rather than the Rav: the structure of Ana Becoach, the Kiddushin source, the Shulchan Aruch and Mishnah

> *Berurah citations, the contents of the closing mishnah, the attribution of the three reasons to the Tur, Abudraham and Beis Yosef, the content of Kegavna, the Piaseczner's source, the "baruch hu" question (an error of the Plaud summary), and the Sefardi placement. These are corrected in the shiur HTML. What was lost is also real: the dedication, Alkabetz and Manos HaLevi, the biographies of Anan, the Piaseczner and the Chayei Adam, and the Rav's plain statements of doubt. Open research items: the Tosafos in Chagigah, the Aruch HaShulchan, the Geonic and Rishonic sources for the three reasons, the Zohar reference, and the Chayei Adam.*

Produced by a content-based review pass — checked against the primary bilingual transcript, with the Plaud transcript and summary as secondary sources, the draft English write-up, and Sefaria. Complement to the Independent Editorial Review.